Interviewing a Coach

A checklist for clubs

COACH IN MIND
Shaping coaches minds on & off the pitch

Before confirming any coaching appointment, work through this checklist during or shortly after the interview. It covers the essentials — sighting the right paperwork and asking the right questions — so nothing gets missed in the excitement of finding a good fit.

Before you appoint

- [ ] **1. Sighted their current Licence/Diploma**
  Ask to physically see (or receive a copy of) their coaching accreditation. From C Licence upward, these are referred to as a Licence/Diploma (C Licence, B Licence, A Licence, or Pro Diploma) — confirm it matches or exceeds what the role requires.

- [ ] **2. Confirmed the Licence/Diploma is current**
  Accreditation can lapse or expire. Check the issue date and any renewal requirements rather than assuming a Licence/Diploma sighted once is still valid.

- [ ] **3. Sighted a valid, current WWCC (or your state's equivalent)**
  Every state and territory requires some form of Working With Children check before someone can coach minors — the exact name and process varies by jurisdiction, so confirm the specific requirement for your state and sight current proof of it.

- [ ] **4. Confirmed Play Football registration**
  Check whether the coach is already registered as a coach on Play Football, or is willing to register before starting. This is separate from their club-level paperwork.

- [ ] **5. Asked about any history of disciplinary suspensions**
  Ask directly whether they have ever been suspended or disciplined as a coach, by any club, league, or federation. Follow up on anything disclosed before proceeding.

State/territory WWCC requirements and naming vary — if you're unsure which check applies, confirm with your state's Working With Children screening authority before proceeding.

Candidate name: _____ Club: _____

Interviewed by: _____ Date: _____

This checklist is a practical starting point, not legal advice — clubs remain responsible for meeting their own state/territory's child safety and coach screening obligations in full.